

THE COLONIAL LEGACY & THE FOUNDATIONS OF THE REPUBLIC

THE BALANCE SHEET THE → HOW UNDERDEVELOPMENT WAS DEVELOPED → THE AGRARIAN LEGACY IN → THE HUMAN BASELINE OF → THE STATE THAT WAS → THREE FRANCHISES, ONE BREAK

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

THE BALANCE SHEET THE REPUBLIC OPENED WITH

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COLONIAL LIABILITY (ECONOMIC AND ADMINISTRATIVE)

MOVEMENT ASSET (POLITICAL) DEPENDENT, STAGNANT, FAMINE-PRONE ECONOMY

TESTED ALL-INDIA LEADERSHIP MASS ILLITERACY AND LOW LIFE EXPECTANCY

PARTY ORGANISED IN EVERY PROVINCE RENTIER AGRICULTURE, RISING LANDLESSNESS

DEMOCRACY, CIVIL LIBERTIES, SECULARISM APPARATUS BUILT FOR EXTRACTION AND

THREE DECADES OF PRACTISED ORGANISATION

HOW DID THE SECOND COLUMN CARRY THE FIRST WITHOUT

CORE CLAIM

COLONIAL LIABILITY (economic and administrative)

MOVEMENT ASSET (political) dependent, stagnant, famine-prone economy

tested all-India leadership mass illiteracy and low life expectancy

party organised in every province rentier agriculture, rising landlessness

MECHANISM

democracy, civil liberties, secularism apparatus built for extraction and order

three decades of practised organisation

CENTRAL QUESTION → how did the second column carry the first without collapsing?

ERROR TO AVOID → merging the columns and crediting the empire with Indian democracy.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

MUST REMEMBER: Colonial legacies included centralised administration, civil services, army, law, railways, economic

underdevelopment and classificatory practices, while the national movement supplied democratic and federal resources.

CORE CLAIM

• COLONIAL LIABILITY (economic and administrative)

• MOVEMENT ASSET (political) dependent, stagnant, famine-prone economy

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• underdevelopment and classificatory practices, while the national movement supplied democratic and federal resources.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Colonial legacies included centralised administration, civil services, army, law, railways, economic underdevelopment and classificatory practices, while the national movement supplied democratic and federal resources.

01

STAGE 01

HOW UNDERDEVELOPMENT WAS DEVELOPED

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SUBORDINATE INTEGRATION WITH THE WORLD CAPITALIST SYSTEM SINCE THE

FORCED INTERNATIONAL DIVISION OF LABOUR

RAW MATERIALS OUT, MANUFACTURES IN

REAL CHANGE IN RAILWAYS, ADMINISTRATION, EDUCATION, FINANCE AND COMMUNICATIONS

BUT CHANGE OPERATING INSIDE A COLONIAL FRAME CRYSTALLISES A

POVERTY, DEPENDENCE AND SUBORDINATION REPRODUCED RATHER THAN GROWTH GENERATED

THE PHRASE DEVELOPMENT OF UNDERDEVELOPMENT BELONGS TO A. GUNDER

SUBORDINATE INTEGRATION with the world capitalist system since the 1750s

forced international division of labour: raw materials out, manufactures in

real change in railways, administration, education, finance and communications

but change operating INSIDE a colonial frame crystallises a dependent structure

poverty, dependence and subordination reproduced rather than growth generated

CORE CLAIM

• SUBORDINATE INTEGRATION with the world capitalist system since the 1750s

• forced international division of labour: raw materials out, manufactures in

MECHANISM

• real change in railways, administration, education, finance and communications

• but change operating INSIDE a colonial frame crystallises a dependent structure

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• poverty, dependence and subordination reproduced rather than growth generated

• ATTRIBUTION → the phrase development of underdevelopment belongs to A. Gunder Frank.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ATTRIBUTION → the phrase development of underdevelopment belongs to A. Gunder Frank.

02

STAGE 02

THE AGRARIAN LEGACY IN ATTRIBUTED NUMBERS

THE AGRARIAN LEGACY IN ATTRIBUTED NUMBERS

SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE PER CAPITA AGRICULTURAL PRODUCTION

FALLS ABOUT 14% BETWEEN 1901 AND 1941 PER CAPITA

FALLS FURTHER THAN TOTAL PRODUCTION LANDLESS AGRICULTURAL LABOURERS

ABOUT 13% IN 1871 RISING TO ABOUT 28% BY

REPORTED AS OVER 70% IN THE LOCAL TEXT

LANDLORDS, MONEYLENDERS, MERCHANTS AND THE COLONIAL REVENUE STATE

RACK-RENTING AND USURY ARE SAFER THAN INVESTMENT, SO STAGNATION

CORE CLAIM

SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE per capita agricultural production

falls about 14% between 1901 and 1941 per capita foodgrains

falls further than total production landless agricultural labourers

MECHANISM

about 13% in 1871 rising to about 28% by 1951 land controlled by landlords by the 1940s

reported as over 70% in the local text

STRUCTURE → landlords, moneylenders, merchants and the colonial revenue state

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

INCENTIVE → rack-renting and usury are safer than investment, so stagnation is rational.

CORE CLAIM

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• falls about 14% between 1901 and 1941 per capita foodgrains

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MECHANISM

• about 13% in 1871 rising to about 28% by 1951 land controlled by landlords by the 1940s

• reported as over 70% in the local text

• STRUCTURE → landlords, moneylenders, merchants and the colonial revenue state

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• INCENTIVE → rack-renting and usury are safer than investment, so stagnation is rational.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INCENTIVE → rack-renting and usury are safer than investment, so stagnation is rational.

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CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE per capita agricultural production	about 13% in 1871 rising to about 28% by 1951 land controlled by landlords by the 1940s	INCENTIVE → rack-renting and usury are safer than investment, so stagnation is rational.
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falls further than total production landless agricultural labourers	STRUCTURE → landlords, moneylenders, merchants and the colonial revenue state	

CORE CLAIM

- SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE per capita agricultural production
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MECHANISM

- about 13% in 1871 rising to about 28% by 1951 land controlled by landlords by the 1940s
- reported as over 70% in the local text
- STRUCTURE → landlords, moneylenders, merchants and the colonial revenue state

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- INCENTIVE → rack-renting and usury are safer than investment, so stagnation is rational.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INCENTIVE → rack-renting and usury are safer than investment, so stagnation is rational.

03

STAGE 03

THE HUMAN BASELINE OF 1951

THE HUMAN BASELINE OF 1951

SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE (1951 UNLESS STATED) ILLITERACY, ALL INDIANS

NEARLY 84 PER CENT ILLITERACY, WOMEN

ABOUT 92 PER CENT; ABOUT 8 LITERATE WOMEN IN

BARELY 32 YEARS FOR AN INDIAN BORN BETWEEN 1940

ABOUT 25 PER 1,000 PERSONS A YEAR INFANT MORTALITY

BETWEEN 175 AND 190 PER 1,000 LIVE BIRTHS

COLONIAL NEGLECT OF MASS, TECHNICAL AND FEMALE EDUCATION, NOT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE (1951 unless stated) illiteracy, all Indians	barely 32 years for an Indian born between 1940 and 1951 death rate, 1941-50	CAUSE → colonial neglect of mass, technical and female education, not poverty alone.
nearly 84 per cent illiteracy, women	about 25 per 1,000 persons a year infant mortality	
about 92 per cent; about 8 literate women in every 100 life expectancy at birth	between 175 and 190 per 1,000 live births	

CORE CLAIM

- SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE (1951 unless stated) illiteracy, all Indians
- nearly 84 per cent illiteracy, women
- about 92 per cent; about 8 literate women in every 100 life expectancy at birth

MECHANISM

- barely 32 years for an Indian born between 1940 and 1951 death rate, 1941-50
- about 25 per 1,000 persons a year infant mortality
- between 175 and 190 per 1,000 live births

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CAUSE → colonial neglect of mass, technical and female education, not poverty alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUSE → colonial neglect of mass, technical and female education, not poverty alone.

04

STAGE 04

THE STATE THAT WAS KEPT RATHER THAN DISMANTLED

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INHERITED APPARATUS

AUTHORITARIAN CORE

REPRESSIVE LAWS FRAMED WITHOUT INDIAN DEMOCRATIC CONSENT

→ WIDE ARBITRARY POWER WITH CIVIL SERVANTS AND POLICE

→ COLLECTOR AND DISTRICT MAGISTRATE IN ONE OFFICE

LIBERAL FRAGMENTS

RULE OF LAW

AUTHORITARIAN CORE → repressive laws framed without Indian democratic consent

→ wide arbitrary power with civil servants and police

→ collector and district magistrate in one office

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
• INHERITED APPARATUS • AUTHORITARIAN CORE → repressive laws framed without Indian democratic consent • → wide arbitrary power with civil servants and police	• → collector and district magistrate in one office • LIBERAL FRAGMENTS → rule of law • relatively independent judiciary	• → press, speech and association tolerated in calm periods • REPUBLIC'S TASK → convert an instrument of order and extraction into one of development • THESIS → continuity with conversion, not rupture; that conversion is the real legacy problem.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIBERAL FRAGMENTS → rule of law | relatively independent judiciary.

05

STAGE 05

THREE FRANCHISES, ONE BREAK

THREE FRANCHISES, ONE BREAK

AFTER 1919

ABOUT 3 PER CENT OF INDIANS COULD VOTE

LEGISLATURES WITH LITTLE POWER

AFTER 1935

ABOUT 15 PER CENT COULD VOTE

SUPREME POWER STILL WITH THE BRITISH

UNIVERSAL ADULT FRANCHISE

AFTER 1919	about 3 per cent of Indians could vote	legislatures with little power
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THE COLONIAL LEGACY & THE FOUNDATIONS OF THE REPUBLIC • TILE 2/5 • same master rows 2240-5474 of 12194 • continues below

LIBERAL FRAGMENTS

RULE OF LAW

INHERITED APPARATUS

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→ wide arbitrary power with civil servants and police

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CORE CLAIM

- INHERITED APPARATUS
- AUTHORITARIAN CORE → repressive laws framed without Indian democratic consent
- → wide arbitrary power with civil servants and police

MECHANISM

- → collector and district magistrate in one office
- LIBERAL FRAGMENTS → rule of law
- relatively independent judiciary

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- → press, speech and association tolerated in calm periods
- REPUBLIC'S TASK → convert an instrument of order and extraction into one of development
- THESIS → continuity with conversion, not rupture; that conversion is the real legacy problem.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIBERAL FRAGMENTS → rule of law | relatively independent judiciary.

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AFTER 1919

about 3 per cent of Indians could vote

legislatures with little power

AFTER 1935

about 15 per cent could vote

supreme power still with the British

REPUBLIC

universal adult franchise

free and fair elections by right

CORE CLAIM

- AFTER 1919
- about 3 per cent of Indians could vote
- legislatures with little power
- AFTER 1935

MECHANISM

- about 15 per cent could vote
- supreme power still with the British
- universal adult franchise
- free and fair elections by right

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- COLONIAL PURPOSE → co-opt and weaken the national movement while keeping the reins
- UNINTENDED EFFECT → Indians gain practical experience of elections and elected organs
- THE BREAK → the republic replaced the colonial franchise; it did not widen it by degrees.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: THE BREAK → the republic replaced the colonial franchise; it did not widen it by degrees.

06

STAGE 06

MOVEMENT ASSETS CONVERTED INTO REPUBLICAN INSTITUTIONS

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NATIONAL MOVEMENT

RAJENDRA PRASAD

NO SINGLE REGION OR COMMUNITY

FIRST NEHRU CABINET OF FOURTEEN INCLUDES FIVE NON-CONGRESSMEN

→ B.R. AMBEDKAR CHAIRS THE DRAFTING COMMITTEE

ACCOMMODATIVE POLITICS; THREE DECADES OF ELECTIONS, ARGUMENT, ORGANISATION

ALL-INDIA SERVICES AND A NATIONAL ARMY ON MERIT, UNDER

NATIONAL MOVEMENT

LEADERSHIP → Nehru

Rajendra Prasad → no single region or community

BREADTH → first Nehru cabinet of fourteen includes five non-Congressmen

CORE CLAIM

- NATIONAL MOVEMENT
- LEADERSHIP → Nehru
- Rajendra Prasad → no single region or community

MECHANISM

- BREADTH → first Nehru cabinet of fourteen includes five non-Congressmen
- → B.R. Ambedkar chairs the Drafting Committee
- HABITS → accommodative politics; three decades of elections, argument, organisation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CONVERSION → all-India services and a national army on merit, under civilian control
- LATER COST → the same dominance becomes the Congress system whose decay is a later topic.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LATER COST → the same dominance becomes the Congress system whose decay is a later topic.

07

STAGE 07

FOUR PRESSURES IN THE SAME MONTHS

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COMMUNAL VIOLENCE

REFUGEE MOVEMENT, KILLING, MINORITY INSECURITY

TELANGANA INSURGENCY

ARMED COMMUNIST CHALLENGE INSIDE THE NEW REPUBLIC

PRINCELY INTEGRATION

MORE THAN 560 UNITS TO ACCEDE, MERGE AND DEMOCRATISE

CONTESTED FRONTIER

CORE CLAIM

- COMMUNAL VIOLENCE → refugee movement, killing, minority insecurity
- TELANGANA INSURGENCY → armed communist challenge inside the new republic
- PRINCELY INTEGRATION → more than 560 units to accede, merge and democratise

MECHANISM

- CONTESTED FRONTIER → fighting and an international reference in Kashmir
- PLUS → a divided army and a divided treasury inherited on the first day
- METHOD → secular reassurance + coercive capacity + reconciliation, democracy not suspended

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CONSEQUENCE → the constitutional preference for a strong centre and emergency provisions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONSEQUENCE → the constitutional preference for a strong centre and emergency provisions.

- LATER COST → the same dominance becomes the Congress system whose decay is a later topic.

STAGE 07 FOUR PRESSURES IN THE SAME MONTHS

MORE THAN 560 UNITS TO ACCEDE, MERGE AND DEMOCRATISE

- CONSEQUENCE → the constitutional preference for a strong centre and emergency provisions.

STAGE 08 READING THE TWO MOST MISUSED FIGURES

WEST FLOW

SAFE SENTENCE → name the author, mark the direction, record that other scholarship differs.

- **SAFE SENTENCE** → name the author, mark the direction, record that other scholarship differs.

STAGE 09 FROM ASSASSINATION TO THE LIFTED BAN

JUN 1949

JULY 1949 → ban lifted on accepted conditions: written and published constitution, cultural activity only

- READING — proscription used and then withdrawn on terms, not permanent suppression.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: A railway, court or bureaucracy is not inherently a benevolent gift or an unchanged colonial burden
- purpose, access, financing, adaptation and post-1947 political control must be separated.

STAGE 10 INSURRECTION CONVERTED INTO OPPOSITION

INSURGENCY CONTAINED BY THE STATE WHILE THE POLITICAL DOOR

THEN – party legalised everywhere; leaders and cadres released; elections contested

Pakistan (assets)

communalism retreats sharply

and functionaries arrested

detentions

published constitution, cultural activity only

CORE CLAIM

- JAN 1948 → after a fast by Gandhi, Rs 550 million paid to Pakistan (assets settlement)
- 30 JAN 1948 → Gandhi assassinated by Nathuram Godse → communalism retreats sharply
- IMMEDIATE → Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh banned; leaders and functionaries arrested

MECHANISM

- JUN 1949 → Nehru records a preference for fewer bans and detentions
- JULY 1949 → ban lifted on accepted conditions: written and published constitution, cultural activity only, no violence or secrecy, loyalty to flag and
- Constitution, democratic internal organisation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- READING → proscription used and then withdrawn on terms, not permanent suppression.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: A railway, court or bureaucracy is not inherently a benevolent gift or an unchanged colonial burden
- purpose, access, financing, adaptation and post-1947 political control must be separated.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: A railway, court or bureaucracy is not inherently a benevolent gift or an unchanged colonial burden; purpose, access, financing, adaptation and post-1947 political control must be separated.

10

STAGE 10

INSURRECTION CONVERTED INTO OPPOSITION

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LATE 1946

COMMUNIST-LED PEASANT STRUGGLE DEVELOPS IN TELANGANA INSIDE HYDERABAD STATE

FEB 1948

B.T. RANADIVE LINE DECLARES INDEPENDENCE FALSE AND ADOPTS ARMED

INSURGENCY CONTAINED BY THE STATE WHILE THE POLITICAL DOOR

TELANGANA STRUGGLE CALLED OFF; THE PARLIAMENTARY PATH IS ADOPTED

PARTY LEGALISED EVERYWHERE; LEADERS AND CADRES RELEASED; ELECTIONS CONTESTED

LATE 1946 → Communist-led peasant struggle develops in Telangana inside Hyderabad state

FEB 1948 → B.T. Ranadive line declares independence false and adopts armed struggle

1948-51 → insurgency contained by the state while the political door is kept open

MID-1951 → Telangana struggle called off; the parliamentary path is adopted

THEN → party legalised everywhere; leaders and cadres released; elections contested

CORE CLAIM

- LATE 1946 → Communist-led peasant struggle develops in Telangana inside Hyderabad state
- FEB 1948 → B.T. Ranadive line declares independence false and adopts armed struggle
- 1948-51 → insurgency contained by the state while the political door is kept open

MECHANISM

- MID-1951 → Telangana struggle called off; the parliamentary path is adopted
- THEN → party legalised everywhere; leaders and cadres released; elections contested
- LESSON → the armed challenge was defeated and the party was not abolished.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Nationalist, Marxist, Cambridge, subaltern and feminist readings require
- sector-specific evidence rather than a single positive-versus-negative balance sheet.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Nationalist, Marxist, Cambridge, subaltern and feminist readings require sector-specific evidence rather than a single positive-versus-negative balance sheet.

11

STAGE 11

FOUR DOMAINS, TWO DATES AND ONE COMPLETED MAP

FOUR DOMAINS, TWO DATES AND ONE COMPLETED MAP

INTEGRATION, CONSTITUTION 26 NOV 1949

26 JAN 1950, UNIVERSAL ADULT FRANCHISE

STRONG-CENTRE BIAS AND UNRESOLVED REGIONAL QUESTIONS

PLANNED, STATE-LED DEVELOPMENT WITH A PUBLIC-SECTOR CORE AND LAND-REFORM

SLOW GROWTH AND LAND REFORM LARGELY UNIMPLEMENTED

FROM ABOUT 84 PER CENT ILLITERACY TO DELIBERATE SCIENTIFIC

ELITE-FIRST EXPANSION; PRIMARY AND FEMALE EDUCATION LAG BADLY

POLITY → integration, Constitution 26 Nov 1949 / 26 Jan 1950, universal adult franchise

LIMIT: strong-centre bias and unresolved regional questions

ECONOMY → planned, state-led development with a public-sector core and land-reform law

LIMIT: slow growth and land reform largely unimplemented

EDUCATION → from about 84 per cent illiteracy to deliberate scientific and technical investment

CORE CLAIM

- POLITY → integration, Constitution 26 Nov 1949 / 26 Jan 1950, universal adult franchise
- LIMIT: strong-centre bias and unresolved regional questions
- ECONOMY → planned, state-led development with a public-sector core and land-reform law
- LIMIT: slow growth and land reform largely unimplemented

MECHANISM

- EDUCATION → from about 84 per cent illiteracy to deliberate scientific and technical investment
- LIMIT: elite-first expansion; primary and female education lag badly
- INT. REL. → non-alignment and Asian solidarity; Pondicherry 1954; Goa 17 December 1961
- LIMIT: limited hard power

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- TWO DATES → independence 15 Aug 1947
- republic 26 Jan 1950; the 2026 parade is the 77th precisely because 1950 counts as the first
- DO NOT CONFUSE → Operation Vijay (Goa, Dec 1961) with Operation Polo (Hyderabad, Sep 1948).

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DO NOT CONFUSE → Operation Vijay (Goa, Dec 1961) with Operation Polo (Hyderabad, Sep 1948).

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

THE COLONIAL ECONOMY WAS STRUCTURALLY DEPENDENT — COMMERCIALISED AGRICULTURE

GROWTH, ARRESTED INDUSTRIALISATION, AND A STATE GEARED TO EXTRACTION

LANDLESS AGRICULTURAL LABOUR HAD RISEN FROM ABOUT 13% (1871)

THE PARADOX OF 1947 IS THAT INDIA WAS ECONOMICALLY

THE MOST CONFIDENT — BECAUSE THE FREEDOM STRUGGLE HAD

CHANDRA'S ARGUMENT

THE NATIONAL MOVEMENT " INDIGENISED DEMOCRACY ," GIVING

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- The colonial economy was structurally dependent — commercialised agriculture without productivity
- growth, arrested industrialisation, and a state geared to extraction, not development.
- Landless agricultural labour had risen from about 13% (1871) to 28% (1951) , a marker of colonial agrarian distress.
- CAUTION: The paradox of 1947 is that India was economically among the poorest nations yet politically among

ADVANCED DEBATE

- the most confident — because the freedom struggle had already built a democratic, participatory political culture.
- CAUTION: Chandra's argument: the national movement " indigenised democracy ," giving
- the new institutions a legitimacy that most decolonising states lacked.
- Four simultaneous threats — communal violence, the Telangana insurgency, princely-state integration, and

LEGACY / NUANCE

- the Kashmir war — could have Balkanised or militarised the state.
- The leadership chose secularism plus force plus reconciliation : containing riots, banning and then rehabilitating
- the RSS, integrating states, and defeating the Communist insurgency while keeping the CPI legal.
- CAUTION: The decision to adopt universal adult franchise at once — in a poor, largely illiterate

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.